

Service and Citizenship

Michael P. O'Donnell

I view service as an integral component of academic life, parallel to my commitments to research, teaching, and mentorship. My efforts focus on strengthening departmental culture, enhancing trainee development, and contributing to the broader scientific community in ways that promote rigor, inclusivity, and collaboration.

Departmental Service

Within MCDB, I currently serve as interim Chair of the Community and Professional Climate Committee and have been a member since 2021. This committee, which includes faculty, trainees, and staff, works to foster a collegial and inclusive environment through initiatives that promote transparency, dialogue, and shared responsibility for departmental culture. I have also served on the MCDB Graduate Affairs Committee and participated in multiple faculty searches, contributing to graduate policy discussions, recruitment strategies, and hiring decisions that shape the department's long-term direction. In addition, I co-organized the MCDB annual retreat twice and have served on numerous doctoral candidacy and thesis advisory committees across MCDB and affiliated programs.

University Service

I have been actively involved in graduate admissions through the MCGD/BBS admissions committee and recruitment weekends since 2021. I regularly review applications for the Yale College Dean's Research Fellowship and contribute to university-wide initiatives as a member of the Wu Tsai Institute and the Learning Environment Subcommittee of the Yale School of Medicine. I also organize the interdepartmental *C. elegans* seminar series, strengthening cross-campus collaboration.

Professional Service

Nationally and internationally, I organize workshops, review manuscripts, and mentor trainees within the *C. elegans* community. I am an active member of the Society for Neuroscience and the Genetics Society of America. Through these efforts, I aim to support rigorous peer review and foster collaborative scientific communities.